

**LEVEL**  
**Intermediate**

**NUMBER  
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**LANGUAGE**  
English



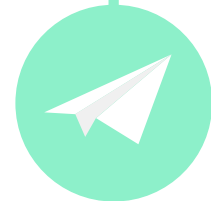


## Goals

- Can use some more advanced expressions to ask for and accept a favour.
- Can use modal verbs to make polite interruptions during a conversation.



Who can you ask if you **need a favour**?  
Do you feel comfortable asking your  
colleagues for help when you need it?





## Conversation techniques

In this lesson, you're going to learn **advanced conversation techniques** so that you can **ask for favours**, speak with **confidence**, and **interrupt** others when necessary.



I need a favour.



## Asking for a favour

Here are some phrases you can use to **ask someone for a favour**. If you want to be very **polite**, you can use **modal verbs**.

### Asking for a favour

Have you got a minute? 😊

I need a favour.

Would you be able to...? 😊

Is there any chance you could...?

Could you do me a favour?



Is there any chance you could give me some information about web development?

## Refusing to do a favour

Sometimes, we have to **say no** when someone asks us to do them a **favour**. We should try to say no as **politely** as possible, so here are some phrases to do that.



I would if I could but I'm so busy this week.



I'd like to help but I can't this afternoon.

## Accepting a favour

If someone says that they will **do you a favour**, you should say **thank you** – of course!  
It can be **more or less formal** depending on who you are talking to.



**Thanks** so much!

Thanks a million



**Thank you**, Sarah, that's really helpful.



## Fill in the gaps

Fill in the gaps with words from the previous pages.

1. I would if I could, but I've got a lot to do today.
2. Is there any chance you could work late tomorrow?
3. I need a favour.
4. I'd like to help but I have to pick up my children from school tonight.
5. Would you be able to read through my CV before I send it?





## Speaking

Decide if these phrases are for accepting or refusing to do a favour. Can you think of any more?

Refusing

I'm not sure if I  
can.

Accepting

That'll be  
brilliant, thanks.  
great

Ben, thank you  
for agreeing to  
this.

Accepting

I wish I could but  
I really can't  
today.

Refusing



## Speaking

**What kind of favours do people often ask for at work?**

to provide information  
to work on the design of a presentation  
to make appointments with customers

Providing information on exercises or assignments



To work late

To make someone  
a cup of tea

## Interrupting

Sometimes, when you need to ask for a favour it might be necessary to **interrupt**. That means, **stopping the person from talking** and **asking a question** or **making a statement**.

You might also need to **interrupt** when one person is **dominating a conversation** or you **didn't understand** something.

To interrupt politely, we often use **modal verbs** like *may*, *could*, and *would*.



## Interrupting politely

- If you want or need to **interrupt someone** while they are speaking, **it is good to do it politely**. To do that, we often use **modal verbs**.

### Try using these phrases

Could I please say something about that?

Could you please repeat that?

May I interrupt you for a second?

May I ask you a question about that?

Would you mind explaining that again?





## Stronger interruptions

- If necessary, you might also need to **interrupt more assertively**.
- The following phrases **could sound rude** so **be careful when you use them!**



**Just a moment!**

Just one moment please

**Wait a minute, please.**





## Unscramble

Could I say something about that, please?

A

say

about

please

something

could I

that



B

a

may I

for

interrupt

second

you

May I interrupt you for a second?



## Interrupt each other

**Have a conversation about your work (where you work, what you do, what it's like, etc.) with your classmates and/or teacher and practise interrupting when the other person is speaking.  
Try to interrupt both politely and more assertively.**





## Fill in the gaps



Henry, listen to this! I just heard the funniest...

Yes, sure. Is everything ok?

I <sup>would if</sup>  
wish/ I could but I have to pick my son up at 4pm too!

Sorry, Jen. May I interrupt you for a second?

<sup>need to ask you for</sup>  
I need a favour. I am supposed to be working until 6pm tonight but I need to collect my son at 4. Is there any chance you could take my last meeting?



## Role play

**Role play a conversation between two colleagues. Look back at p.16 to help you and swap roles when you are done.**

How long have you worked in this job?

I have finished my studies at the beginning of 2021



**Student A:**

**You are talking to your colleague. When they interrupt and ask for a favour, decide if you will say yes or no.**

**Student B:**

**You have a problem and you need to interrupt student A and ask for a favour.**



## Game

■ Tell your classmates about 2 big favours you have done for someone. One should be true and one should be a lie. Your classmates have to guess which is which.



I walked my neighbour's dog for a month.

Hmm that might be true.

I cleaned my sister's house when she was on holiday.

No way! I think the dog walking is true.



## Reflect on the goals

Go back to the second slide of the lesson and check if you have achieved all the goals of the lesson.

yes

no





## Reflect on this lesson

Think about everything you have seen in this lesson.  
What were the most difficult activities or words? The easiest?



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\_\_\_\_\_



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\_\_\_\_\_



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\_\_\_\_\_



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If you have time, go over  
the most difficult slides again



## Answer key

### Exercise p. 16

Interrupt, need, chance, wish

### Exercise p. 14

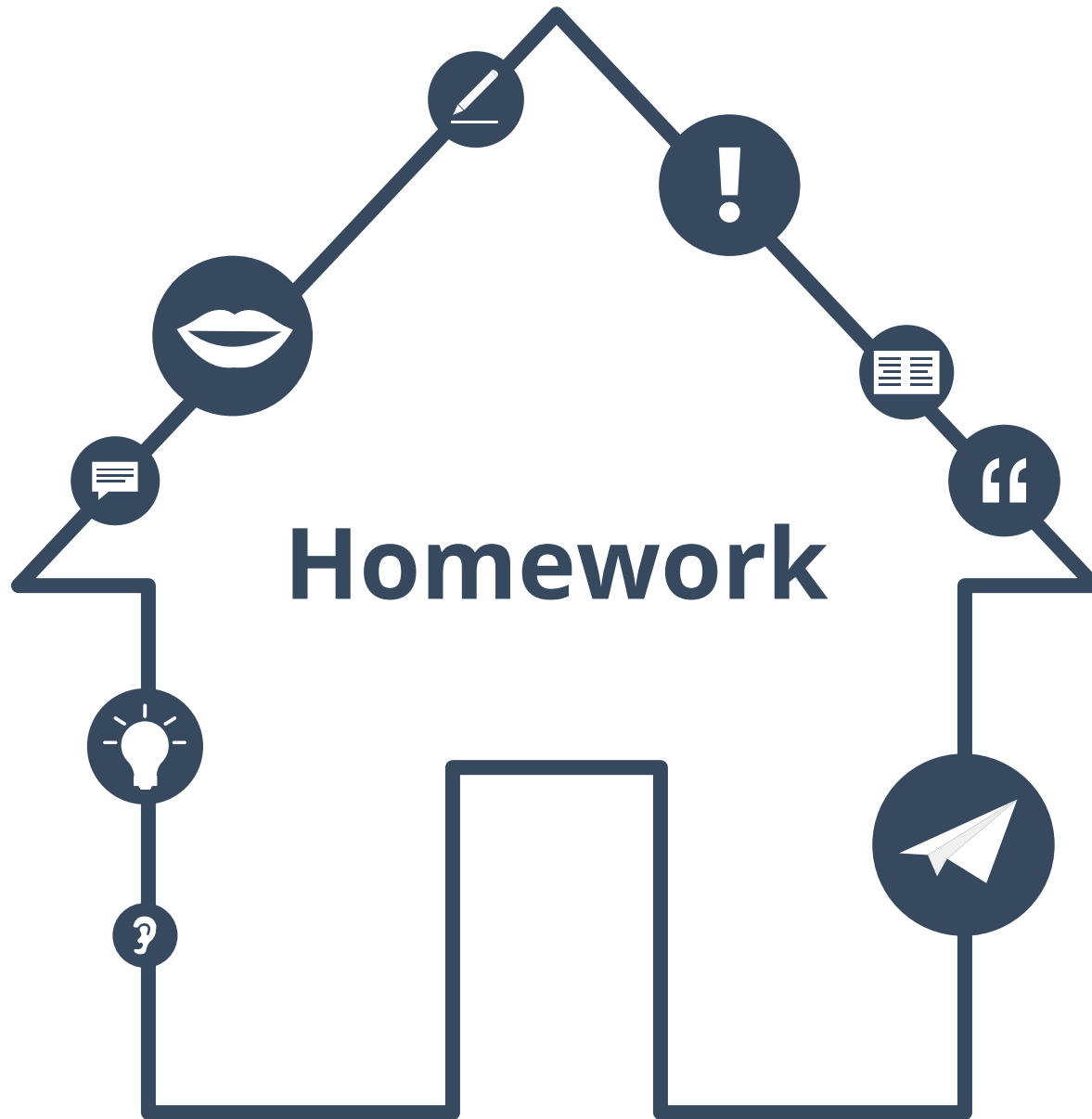
A. Could I say something about that please? B. May I interrupt you for a second?

### Exercise p. 9

Accepting: That'll be brilliant, thanks. Ben, thank you for agreeing to this.  
Refusing: I'm not sure if I can. I wish I could but I really can't today.

### Exercise p. 8

1. could, 2. chance, 3. favour, 4. help, 5. Would





## Categorise

10. Could you do me a favour?



## Write a dialogue

**Write a dialogue similar to the role play that you did on p. 17.  
Make sure you use some phrases from the lesson.**

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## Homework answer key

### **Exercise p. 23**

Asking for a favour: 2, 3, 6, 9, 10  
Interruptions: 1, 4, 5, 7, 8

